



EN PASSANT

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EXPECT A TOUGH STRUGGLE EVERY DAY IN THE 14-GAME MATCH

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I am excited about the upcoming World Chess Championship match in Singapore between Ding Liren and D. Gukesh. It has a lot of very interesting plots to it.

It is the first all-Asian title match in the history of the World Championship. I believe that a rivalry between India and China will be fascinating to watch. And this is a historic match, as Gukesh is the world's youngest challenger of all time.

Now, at the age of 18, he also has the possibility of becoming the youngest World Champion. And I think the location in Singapore is also fantastic. It shows the

heightened global interest in chess.

I expect a tough struggle every day in the 14-game match. The participants will be probing each other for weaknesses right from the beginning.

They both have quite combative styles. Gukesh is very aggressive, while Ding can be a bit more positional, though he is also capable of mixing up the struggle, as he showed in his World Title match last year against Ian Nepomniachtchi; he had displayed great resilience in coming back from setbacks several times. I think the match in Singapore will be fascinating from Game 1.